Platform Incident Runbook

Severity levels

SEV1 means the shipment tracking platform is down for all customers, SEV2 means a major feature is degraded, and SEV3 means a minor issue with a workaround. SEV1 incidents page the on call engineer and the engineering manager immediately.

First response

The incident commander opens a channel named inc followed by the date, posts a status update every 30 minutes for SEV1 and every 60 minutes for SEV2, and records the timeline as events happen.

Platform Incident Runbook

Database failover

If the primary tracking database is unreachable for more than 5 minutes, promote the read replica in the secondary region using the failover pipeline. Confirm replication lag is below 30 seconds before promoting to avoid data loss.

Postmortems

Every SEV1 and SEV2 incident needs a blameless postmortem published within 5 working days, with action items that have named owners and due dates.